The one-page sources scoring checklist

the exact rubric the research-scope-mcp server runs on every source — keep it by your review table

Score every source 0–100 across five dimensions before it earns a citation number. The server returns this evidence with every score — a score is auditable, not a vibe.

1 Availability & substance	**20**	Reachable (HTTP 200) and extractable text *length: 3,000+ chars vs thin/stub pages.* *Dead pages score 0 — dead-link, no*
2 Primary-source status	**32**	Who is TALKING? A primary host *(gov/edu/filings/standards) — or the claim-* *maker speaking for itself (press release,*
3 Freshness	**24**	Publication date found + dated: ≤30d full *marks → decaying → 2 pts past 5 years.* *UNDATED = 0 here and a hard design rule:*
4 Access	**12**	Open and loadable in full. Paywall / *registration walls lose most of this — cite* *what your reader can actually open.*
5 Independence	**12**	No sponsored/affiliate/partnership markers, *no vendor page scoring its own product. The* *claim page itself is evidence OF the claim,*

GRADE BANDS: A ≥ 80 · B ≥ 65 · C ≥ 45 · D < 45 *Kill rules: < 45 = cannot cite · < 2 sources ≥ 45 = report 'insufficient sources' · number + paywa*

THE REPORT SHELL — write your report INSIDE this shape and citations become mechanical:

```
# <Report title>  (+ date, + author)
## Claims   (one editable truth per line/bullet, tagged [S1] [S2] like the example)
  . The 2025 redesign moved EMT testing to CAT (70-120 items) [S2]
## Citation registry   (one line per source, numbered [Sn])
  [S1] <url> - score 88/100 (A, published 2025-04)     (from the server's fetch_and_score)
  [S2] <url> - score 71/100 (B, no date)   (the 'no date' flag is IN the file, visible to the reader)
## Scoring appendix   (per-source flags; where a reader audits you in 90 seconds)
```

THE 4-STEP LOOP (what the server automates):

1. plan_research(scope) => source targets + kill criteria, before touching a browser
2. fetch_and_score(url) => the rubric above, run mechanically, one line per source
3. build_report(topic, sources) => this shell, generated with your scored sources married in
4. check_report() => every claim must cite >=1 scored source; orphans come back as ERRORS